



To Whom It May Concern,

I am pleased to recommend Umeshkumar Ghaskata for the Research Intern – AI Hardware position at Microsoft Research. I have had the opportunity to work with Umesh for over eight months at the University at Buffalo, where he has served as a Research Associate on two NIH-funded projects: “*Measuring E-Cigarette Use in Real Time via Wearable Sensor*” and “*AI-Enhanced App-based Intervention for Adolescent E-Cigarette Cessation*.” His primary role involved developing an app-based intervention to support e-cigarette cessation among adolescents and young adults.

Umesh has demonstrated strong technical expertise in cross-platform app development for both Android and iOS. He played a key role in designing the overall system architecture and developing core components, including interactive game features, a personalized AI-driven chatbot, and a robust backend system with database integration and user authentication. He is highly resourceful and consistently contributed to troubleshooting complex challenges, including those related to our AI-enhanced smartwatch-based e-cigarette detection system.

In addition to his technical strengths, Umesh is an effective communicator. He is able to clearly explain complex technical concepts to both technical and non-technical team members, facilitating collaboration across disciplines. He is also proactive in addressing and resolving miscommunications within the team.

Umesh is reliable, punctual, and demonstrates a strong work ethic. He consistently meets deadlines, provides clear and timely updates, and takes full ownership of his responsibilities. He has never missed a meeting and is always well prepared. Notably, he shows initiative in addressing unexpected challenges and delivers high-quality work with minimal supervision.

Based on my experience mentoring and working with many students and research staff over the years, I would place Umesh among the top 5% I have worked with in my career. This distinction reflects not only his technical ability, but also his professionalism, initiative, and collaborative mindset.

He is a highly valued member of our team who demonstrates strong initiative, leadership potential, and a genuine eagerness to learn. I am confident that he will thrive in a rigorous, research-driven environment such as Microsoft Research.

I strongly recommend Umesh for this opportunity. Please feel free to contact me if you require any additional information.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading 'Anthea Park'.

Eunhee Park, PhD, RN, FAAN

Associate Professor

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